yt2audio — How to use it

A local website that turns your own YouTube videos, playlists or channels into MP3 or M4A files. It runs only on your computer.

1. Setup (one time)

In PowerShell:

```
winget install OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS
winget install yt-dlp.yt-dlp
winget install Gyan.FFmpeg
```

Then close PowerShell and open a new one so it finds the new programs.

2. Run it

```
cd C:\Users\<you>\Downloads\yt2audio
node server.js
```

Open **http://localhost:8765** in your browser. Keep PowerShell open while you use it; press **Ctrl+C** to stop.

3. Use it

1) Paste links, one per line — a video, playlist or whole channel (e.g. https://www.youtube.com/@YourChannel/videos).
2) Pick **MP3** or **M4A** (M4A keeps original quality).
3) Click **Convert** and watch the progress box.
4) Files appear under **Your files** — click one to download it.

Files are saved to **C:\Users\<you>\Music\yt2audio\<channel>\<title>.mp3**. Videos already done are skipped next time (tracked in **.done.txt** in that folder).

4. The files

server.js

The local web server. Connects the page to convert.js and serves your files.

Input	POST /convert receives { links, format } from the page.
Output	GET /files lists saved files; GET /file?p=... downloads one.
Change	PORT (website address) near the top.

convert.js

The core. Runs yt-dlp to turn links into audio. Knows nothing about the website.

Input	convert(links, format, onLine, done).
Output	Audio files in OUT_DIR; progress lines via onLine; exit code via done.
Change	OUT_DIR (save folder); the args list (yt-dlp options, file naming).

public/index.html

The page layout.

Input	Link box (id=links) and format dropdown (id=fmt); Convert button (id=go).
Output	Progress box (id=log) and file list (id=files).
Change	Add or move page elements. Keep the ids if app.js uses them.

public/style.css

How the page looks. Doesn't affect how anything works.

Change	Colors, sizes, fonts.

public/app.js

Runs in the browser. Sends what you typed to the server, shows progress and files.

Input	Reads the link box and dropdown when Convert is clicked.
Output	Writes progress into the log box; loadFiles() fills the file list.

5. How it fits together

```
index.html + app.js  --POST /convert-->  server.js  --convert()-->  convert.js  --> yt-dlp
   (INPUT)                                                                          |
   file list  <--GET /files, /file--  server.js  <---- audio files in OUT_DIR (OUTPUT)
```

Swapping the HTML for something else: replace the **public** folder with a different page, or skip the website and call convert() yourself, for example:

```
const { convert } = require('./convert');
convert(['https://youtu.be/VIDEO_ID'], 'mp3', console.log, code => console.log('done', code));
```

6. Problems

yt-dlp not found — install it (step 1) and reopen PowerShell.
Download errors — run `yt-dlp -U` to update it; YouTube changes often.
Page won't open — make sure `node server.js` is still running.

Use it only for videos you own or have permission to download.